

NovaCart

Product & Order Policy

Document Type: Customer & Support Knowledge Base Policy

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Status: Active for Autonomous Customer Support Copilot Demo

Policy Area	Product information, availability and order management
Applies To	NovaCart products and customer orders
Order Confirmation	Provided after successful order validation and applicable payment processing
Supported Region	India
Support Email	support@novacart.example
Support Hours	Monday–Sunday, 9:00 AM–9:00 PM IST

1. Purpose

This Product & Order Policy defines the general rules for product information, availability, pricing, order placement, order confirmation, order status, and common order-related customer questions.

This document is designed to provide consistent customer guidance and to serve as an authoritative knowledge source for the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot.

2. Product Information

NovaCart product listings may contain information such as:

- Product name and description.
- Product category.
- Available variants such as size, color, model, or capacity.
- Product specifications.
- Images and product highlights.
- Price and applicable offers.
- Availability or stock status.
- Delivery information.

Customers should rely on the latest product listing for the current product details. If product information appears inconsistent, the issue may require review rather than an assumed answer.

3. Product Availability and Stock

Product availability can change based on inventory and order demand.

Common stock states include:

- In stock — the product is currently available for ordering.

- Limited stock — availability is low and may change quickly.
- Out of stock — the product cannot currently be ordered.
- Temporarily unavailable — the product may return later.
- Discontinued — the product is no longer expected to be available.

The AI assistant should not promise that an out-of-stock product will be restocked unless an approved source provides that information.

4. Product Variants

Some products are available in multiple variants. Customers should select the required variant before placing an order.

Examples include:

- Size.
- Color.
- Model.
- Storage capacity.
- Pack quantity.
- Configuration.

Availability and price can differ between variants. The assistant should answer based on the selected variant when that information is available.

5. Product Pricing

The product price displayed at the time of checkout is the relevant price for the order, subject to applicable taxes, shipping charges, discounts, and other clearly displayed conditions.

Prices may change over time. The AI assistant should not guarantee that a previous price will remain available for a future order unless the applicable offer explicitly provides such a guarantee.

6. Discounts and Promotional Offers

Promotional offers may have conditions such as:

- Minimum order value.
- Eligible products or categories.
- Validity period.
- Customer eligibility.
- Maximum discount.
- Coupon or promotional code requirements.
- Payment-method restrictions.

The assistant should explain only the conditions supported by the available offer information and should not invent discount eligibility.

7. Order Placement

A customer can generally place an order by:

1. Selecting an available product and required variant.
2. Adding the product to the cart.
3. Reviewing the cart.
4. Providing or selecting the delivery address.
5. Selecting an available payment method.
6. Reviewing the order summary.
7. Confirming the order.

An order is not necessarily confirmed merely because the customer reached the payment stage. The final order status should be checked.

8. Order Confirmation

An order should be treated as confirmed only when NovaCart records a successful order confirmation.

Customers may receive an order confirmation through the application, email, or another supported notification channel.

If payment appears successful but no order confirmation is available, the customer should not be told that the order definitely exists. Payment and order records may need to be reconciled.

9. Payment Successful but Order Not Confirmed

If a customer reports that money was deducted but the order was not confirmed, the issue should be handled as a payment/order reconciliation case.

The assistant may request:

- Order information, if any.
- Transaction or payment reference.
- Payment amount.
- Approximate payment time.
- Available payment receipt.

The assistant should not promise an order confirmation or refund before the transaction status is verified. A ticket may be created when system-level investigation is required.

10. Order Statuses

Typical order statuses include:

- Pending — order creation or payment processing is not yet complete.
- Confirmed — order has been successfully accepted.
- Processing — order is being prepared.
- Packed — product has been prepared for shipment.
- Shipped — order has been handed to the delivery partner.
- Out for delivery — delivery is in progress.
- Delivered — delivery has been recorded as completed.
- Cancelled — order was cancelled.

- Return requested — a return process has been initiated.
- Refunded — an eligible refund has been completed according to the applicable refund process.

Actual status names may vary by system implementation.

11. Order Modification

Customers may request changes to an order such as quantity, variant, or delivery address.

Modification availability depends on the current order stage. Changes are generally easier before processing or shipment begins.

Once an order has entered a non-modifiable stage, the customer may need to cancel and place a new order if cancellation is still available, or use the applicable return process after delivery.

12. Quantity Limits

Certain products or promotional offers may have purchase limits.

A quantity limit may be applied because of:

- Limited inventory.
- Promotional conditions.
- Product restrictions.
- Operational requirements.
- Fraud or abuse prevention.

The assistant should not advise customers to bypass a quantity limit.

13. Out-of-Stock Products

If a product is out of stock, customers may need to wait until inventory becomes available or choose an alternative product.

The assistant may suggest checking:

- Product availability later.
- Other available variants.
- Similar products.
- Approved restock notifications, if supported.

The assistant should not provide an invented restock date.

14. Duplicate Orders

If a customer accidentally places the same order multiple times, the customer should identify the relevant order numbers.

Support should verify the status of each order. If an order is still cancellable, the Cancellation Policy applies. If a duplicate order has already shipped, the customer may need to use the Return Policy after delivery, if eligible.

15. Incorrect Product Information

If a customer believes the product listing contains incorrect information, the issue should be reported with the relevant product name or identifier and a description of the discrepancy.

The assistant should not override official product information based only on an unsupported customer assumption. When a listing appears inconsistent across systems, the case should be escalated for verification.

16. Product Not as Expected

If a customer receives a product that differs materially from the product description, selected variant, or ordered item, the case may qualify for return or replacement under the Return Policy.

Customers may be asked for order details and appropriate evidence such as photographs or product identifiers.

17. Pre-Order or Temporarily Unavailable Products

Some products may be offered as pre-orders or may temporarily be unavailable for immediate shipment.

When a product has a specific availability or dispatch date, that information should be used when responding to customer questions.

The AI assistant should not convert an estimated or tentative date into a guaranteed delivery promise unless the product terms explicitly provide a guarantee.

18. Order History

Customers may generally view their previous orders through their account.

Order history can help customers locate:

- Order numbers.
- Products purchased.
- Order dates.
- Order status.
- Payment or refund references when supported.
- Delivery and return information.

If an order is missing from the account despite evidence that it was placed, the issue may require account or order-system investigation.

19. Customer Questions That Do Not Require a Ticket

Simple informational questions should normally be answered directly using the knowledge base.

Examples:

- “How do I place an order?”
- “What does ‘shipped’ mean?”
- “What does out of stock mean?”
- “Can I change my order before it ships?”
- “Where can I see my order history?”

The Copilot should not create a support ticket merely because a customer asks a normal informational question.

20. Order Issues That May Require a Ticket

A ticket or human escalation may be appropriate when:

- Payment was deducted but no order was created.

- Order status is inconsistent or unavailable.
- A confirmed order disappeared from the customer's account.
- A customer disputes the product, quantity, or variant received.
- A modification cannot be completed automatically.
- A duplicate order requires investigation.
- Product information conflicts across internal sources.
- The issue requires access to internal order or inventory records.

21. Information Required for Order Support

Support may request non-sensitive information such as:

- Order number.
- Product name or identifier.
- Selected variant.
- Approximate order date.
- Description of the issue.
- Transaction reference when a payment issue is involved.

Customers should never provide passwords, OTPs, PINs, or confidential payment credentials.

22. Examples

Example 1 — General order question:

Customer: "How do I place an order?"

Expected handling: Explain the order-placement process. No ticket should be created.

Example 2 — Order status:

Customer: "What does shipped mean?"

Expected handling: Explain that the order has been handed to the delivery partner and provide tracking guidance when available. No ticket is normally required.

Example 3 — Payment deducted:

Customer: "My payment was deducted but I didn't get an order."

Expected handling: Classify as a payment/order issue, request appropriate transaction information, and create a ticket if system verification is required.

Example 4 — Out of stock:

Customer: "When will this product be back?"

Expected handling: Provide an approved restock date only if available. Otherwise explain that no confirmed restock date is available.

Example 5 — Wrong variant:

Customer: "I ordered size M but received size L."

Expected handling: Treat as an order/product issue and guide the customer to the applicable return or replacement process; create/escalate a ticket when verification is needed.

23. Relationship With Other Policies

This Product & Order Policy works together with the Payment Policy, Cancellation Policy, Shipping & Delivery Policy, Return Policy, and Refund Policy.

Product and order questions should first be classified correctly. Payment-specific problems follow the Payment Policy. Cancellation follows the Cancellation Policy. Shipment and delivery issues follow the Shipping & Delivery Policy. Product returns follow the Return Policy, and approved refunds follow the Refund Policy.

24. Policy Authority

This document is the authoritative general product and order source for the NovaCart customer-support knowledge base.

The Autonomous Customer Support Copilot should use current order information together with this policy whenever available. If the required order or product information cannot be verified, the AI assistant should state the limitation and escalate when human investigation is necessary.

This document is fictional and created exclusively for the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot project.